Benjamin Ory

CONTACT INFORMATION

Letteren 04.18
Blijde-Inkomststraat 21 - bus 3313
3000 Leuven, Belgium

Web: https://benjaminory.com
Email: benjaminory@gmail.com

EMPLOYMENT

KU Leuven, Fonds Wetenschappelijk Onderzoek (FWO) Junior Postdoctoral Fellowship, 2025–28
Project: "Connecting Research and Practice: Cataloguing, Curating, and Contextualizing Performances of Early Music, 1915–1960" (Project reference number: 1219125N)

Harvard University, Villa I Tatti Digital Humanities Fellowship, 2024
Stanford University, VPDoR Large Propel Grant, Postdoctoral Fellow, 2023–24
Williams College, Visiting Assistant Professor, 2022

EDUCATION

Stanford University, PhD in Musicology, 2022
Dissertation: "The Origins of a Sixteenth-Century 'In-Between' Generation and the Long Shadow of Early Twentieth-Century German Historiography"
https://purl.stanford.edu/gb578zc4005
Advisor: Jesse Rodin; Committee: Katelijne Schiltz, Karol Berger

Hochschule für Musik Freiburg, post-baccalaureate study in music theory, 2014–15

Harvard University, A.B. in Music, *cum laude* with honors, 2014
Thesis: "Entrenched in the Nineteenth Century: Brahms's Progressive Form in the Symphonic Slow Movements"

PUBLICATIONS

"Schütz, Historiography, and American Musicology," *Schütz Jahrbuch* 47 (2025) [*recte*: 2026]: 103–20.

"Financial Incentives for Music Scholarship: The Case of Armen Carapetyan and the American Institute of Musicology," *Journal of Musicology* 42 (2025): 452–81. https://doi.org/10.1525/jm.2025.42.4.452

"Alfred Einstein's Scholarship, the Italian Madrigal, and *The Italian Madrigal*," *Troja Jahrbuch für Renaissancemusik* 20 (2022) [*recte*: 2025]: 123–38. https://doi.org/10.25371/troja.v20223937

"Edward Lowinsky and the Divisive Politics of the *New Josquin Edition*," *Journal of the American Musicological Society* 78 (2025): 477–515. https://doi.org/10.1525/jams.2025.78.2.477

"Gaps, Galleys, Gombert: The Biography and Reputation of a Sixteenth-Century Composer," in *Music of the Josquin Era: Essays in Honour of Joshua Rifkin*, ed. Mitchell Brauner, David Fallows, and Jesse Rodin (Münster: American Institute of Musicology, 2024), 63–82.

"Review of Jane Bernstein, *Printing Music in Renaissance Rome*," *Journal of the American Musicological Society* 77 (2024): 823–26. https://doi.org/10.1525/jams.2024.77.3.823

"A Motet Wrongly Attributed to Adrian Willaert," *Journal of the Alamire Foundation* 16 (2024): 111–30. https://doi.org/10.1484/J.JAF.5.137256

"Auf dem Weg zu einer neuen Josquin-Ausgabe? Edward Lowinsky und die Josquin-Festival-Konferenz 1971," *Troja Jahrbuch für Renaissancemusik* 19 (2021) [*recte*: 2024]: 103–23. https://doi.org/10.25371/troja.v20213867

"Carapetyan, Armen," in *DEUMM Online: Dizionario enciclopedico universale della musica e dei musicisti* (forthcoming 2026).

"Josquin Attributions by the Numbers," in *Josquin in Focus*, ed. Clare Bokulich, Jesse Rodin, and Emily Zazulia (forthcoming 2026).

"Gustave Reese's *Music in the Renaissance* and Its Historiography of Central Europe," *Troja Jahrbuch für Renaissancemusik* 22 (forthcoming 2026).

Adrian Willaert Opera Omnia: Motets to 1534, vol. 11 in *Corpus Mensurabilis Musicae* 3 (American Institute of Musicology) (in preparation, approximately 250 pp.)

Digital Humanities Projects

The 1520s Project (https://1520s-project.org, technical director Craig Sapp)
Founder and director of an open-access digital library investigating how, when, and where a new style of polyphonic music emerged in the 1520s. Users can browse, search, analyze, listen to, and perform from a growing corpus of 650+ Renaissance scores spanning ca. 1510–1540. Supported by a 2025–28 NEH Scholarly Editions and Translations Grant ($300,000).

Project publications:

"Conclusions from a Big Batch of Music: Applying CRIM's Analysis Tools to The 1520s Project," in *CRIM Project Perspectives: Essays and Experiments from Citations: The Renaissance Imitation Mass* (2023), https://crim-essays.crimproject.org/crim-essays-and-explorations/ory-batch-pieces/.

Mapping the Musical Renaissance (https://renaissancemapping.org)
Co-director with Emily Zazulia (University of California, Berkeley) and Jesse Rodin (Stanford University) of an interactive mapping project exploring connections among Renaissance figures across disciplines. Users can trace geographic, temporal, and interpersonal relationships through a dynamic visual interface. Responsible for web development and interactive mapping. Supported by a 2024 Stanford Humanities Seed Grant ($50,000, co-recipient with Jesse Rodin).

Josquin Research Project (https://josquin.stanford.edu)
Director of Operations for an open-access digital library of Renaissance music, directed by Jesse Rodin (Stanford University) with Craig Sapp as Technical Director, with more than 1,500 scores spanning ca. 1400–ca. 1520. Corpus expansion is supported through the shared 2025–28 NEH Scholarly Editions & Translations Grant ($300,000) described above.

Early Music Concerts Database (https://concertsdatabase.org; under construction)
Director of a research project tracking concerts of medieval and Renaissance music from 1915 to 1960 in Europe and the United States. Addresses questions of canon formation, scholarly networks, and the development of narratives about early music repertoires. Supported by a 2024 FWO Junior Postdoctoral Fellowship.

Fellowships and Awards

Princeton University Library Research Grant, 2026
Award to undertake research in the collected papers of Princeton professor Arthur Mendel.

NEH Scholarly Editions and Translations Grant, $300,000, 2025–28
Recipient with Jesse Rodin and Craig Sapp for the National Endowment for the Humanities project, "A Digital Library of Renaissance Music: Accessible Scholarly Editions, ca. 1420–1540."

FWO Junior Postdoctoral Fellowship, Fonds Wetenschappelijk Onderzoek, Belgium, 2025–28

Villa I Tatti Digital Humanities Fellowship, Harvard University, 2024
Further developed the digital humanities project, The 1520s Project, at Harvard University's Center for Italian Renaissance Studies in Florence, Italy.

Stanford University VPDoR Large Propel Grant, $50,000, 2023–24
Enabled collaboration between The Josquin Research Project and The 1520s Project in preparation for a co-application for National Endowment for the Humanities funding.

Ora Frishberg Saloman Fund Award, American Musicological Society, 2023
Award to undertake research in German university archives for the digital humanities project, Early Music Concerts Database, 1915–1960.

Stanford Mellon Foundation Dissertation Fellowship, 2021–22

University of Chicago Robert L. Platzman Memorial Fellowship, 2022
Examined the collected papers of University of Chicago professor Edward Lowinsky.

AMS NorCal Award in Musicology, 2021
Award for the best graduate student paper presented at the 2021 AMS-NorCal conference: "The 'In Between' Generation: Mid Sixteenth-Century Polyphony and the Long Shadow of Early Twentieth-Century German Historiography"

Stanford CESTA Digital Humanities Graduate Fellow, 2020–21
Developed a database of 200 works from the 1510s and 20s. Used statistical methods and digital tools to identify and visualize the shift in musical style in the mid-1520s.

Deutscher Akademischer Austauschdienst One-Year Research Grant, 2019–20
Worked with Katelijne Schiltz at the Universität Regensburg, Germany
Analyzed Adrian Willaert's early musical style. Undertook historiographical research in German university archives. Restarted Willaert collected-works edition with Schiltz and Irene Holzer.

Teaching

Studying Early Music with Computers: Tools, Formats, and Strategies, AMS, faculty, 2026
Faculty at a two-week National Endowment for the Humanities–funded Summer Institute directed by the American Musicological Society. Led a week-long session with Chris White to help scholars develop digital humanities projects in early music.

Music 140L: Soundscapes of Renaissance Europe, Stanford University, instructor, 2024
Developed a writing-intensive course exploring Renaissance soundscapes through diverse musicological approaches. Collaborated with Stanford's Program in Writing and Rhetoric to teach discipline-specific writing to junior and senior music majors.

Music 234: Soundscapes of Renaissance Europe, Williams College, instructor, 2022
Explored music and sound in Renaissance daily life through topics including chant, architecture, bells, processions, instrumental music, and sacred and secular song. Examined how sound shaped urban experience and expressed political and social power.

Music 143: The Symphony, Williams College, instructor, 2022
Traced the European symphonic tradition from the late eighteenth century through the present, integrating musical analysis with histories of listening and debates about genius, tradition, and musical narrative.

Music 122A: Counterpoint, Stanford University, instructor, 2019
Taught fifteenth- and sixteenth-century counterpoint through analysis and collaborative composition. Students derived stylistic principles from musical examples and applied them in their own model compositions.

Music 24B: Ear Training II, Stanford University, teaching assistant (TA), 2018
Music 144L: Wagner: The Ring of the Nibelung, Stanford University, TA, 2018
Music 19A: Introduction to Music Theory, Stanford University, TA, 2017
Music 42: Music History Since 1830, Stanford University, TA, 2017
Music 122B: Analysis of Tonal Music, Stanford University, TA, 2017
Music 40: Music History to 1600, Stanford University, TA, 2016

Teaching evaluations and materials available on request.

Talks

"Programming the Past: Belgium and the Early Music Performance Tradition," at the Script and Sound Seminar 2026, Brussels (November 2026)

"When did Renaissance Musicians Cross the Alps?" invited presentation at the Second International Digital Musicology Conference at the Institute of Musicology of the Jagiellonian University, Kraków (October 2026)

"The Life and Afterlife of Early Twentieth-Century German Biographies," at the Troja Symposium 2026: *Das Werk im Leben – das Leben im Werk. Biographische Blicke auf Musik und Musiker der Renaissance*, Trossingen (April 2026)

"American Renaissance Musicology and the End of Aesthetics," at *Renegotiating the Musical Masterwork*, Leuven (April 2026)

"Concerts that Shaped the Canon: Early Performances of Medieval and Renaissance Music," at the 2025 Annual Meeting of the American Musicological Society (AMS), Minneapolis (November 2025)

"The Long Shadow of Early Twentieth-Century Schütz Historiography," invited presentation at the 2025 Heinrich Schütz-Fest, Bad Köstritz (October 2025)

"Gustave Reese's *Music in the Renaissance* and its Historiography of Central Europe," invited presentation at the Troja Symposium 2025: *The Low Countries and Central Europe Historiographical Paradigms in Music and the Arts, 1400-1650*, Leuven and Brussels (February 2025)

"Elucidating a Shift in Musical Style using Digital Tools," invited presentation at *Digital Musicology*, the Fryderyk Chopin Institute, Warsaw (October 2024)

"Databases and Mapping," invited presentation for the Digital Literacy Workshop at Villa I Tatti, Harvard University's Center for Italian Renaissance Studies (October 2024)

"Pinpointing an Aesthetic Shift in Renaissance Music: The 1520s Project," invited presentation at Villa I Tatti, Harvard University's Center for Italian Renaissance Studies (October 2024)

"Visualizing Renaissance Music and Data," invited presentation at *Musica2 – Consortium en musicologie numerique*, at Campus Condorcet, Paris (May 2024)

"Connecting Research and Practice: Cataloguing, Curating, and Contextualizing University Performances of Early Music, 1915–1960," invited lecture at Universität Tübingen (December 2023)

"Motets from Willaert's Early Years: A Volume of Motets for the Collected-Works Edition," and chair of the panel "Adrian Willaert: Perspectives for Future Research," at the Medieval and Renaissance Music Conference (MedRen) 2023, Ludwig-Maximilians-Universität, Munich (July 2023)

"Reshaping Incentives for Music Scholarship: Armen Carapetyan and the American Institute of Musicology," invited lecture for the International Musicological Society's History of the IMS Study Group (June 2023)

"The Aesthetic Difficulty of Sacred Polyphony from the 1520s," invited lecture at the Stanford Center for Medieval and Early Modern Studies (May 2023)

"Reshaping Incentives for Music Scholarship: Armen Carapetyan and the American Institute of Musicology," at the 2022 AMS-SEM-SMT Joint Annual Meeting (November 2022)

"Drawing 'Big Data' Conclusions from a Big Batch of Music: Applying CRIM's Analysis Tools to Music from The 1520s Project" invited presentation at *Digital Counterpoints: Exploring Similarity in Renaissance Music, The CRIM Project*, Haverford College (October 2022)

"Reshaping Incentives for Music Scholarship: Armen Carapetyan and the American Institute of Musicology," invited lecture at the Stanford Center for Medieval and Early Modern Studies (April 2022), at the Medieval and Renaissance Music Conference (MedRen) 2022, University of Uppsala (July 2022), and an invited lecture at Ludwig-Maximilians-Universität, Munich (July 2022)

"*The Italian Madrigal* in Exile / Exile in *The Italian Madrigal*," invited presentation with Moritz Kelber at the Troja Symposium 2022: *Das italienische Madrigal. Alfred Einsteins Versuch einer Geschichte der italienischen Profan-Musik im 16. Jahrhundert und die Folgen*, Munich (March 2022)

"The 'In Between' Generation: Mid Sixteenth-Century Polyphony and the Long Shadow of Early Twentieth-Century German Historiography," at the 2021 Annual Meeting of the American Musicological Society (AMS), virtual (November 2021)

"Re-Narrating the "Post-Josquin" Generation," at *Narrating Musicology: The History of Musicology*, University of Bern (September 2021)

"The 1971 Josquin Conference, Edward Lowinsky, and the role of the Émigrés in US Renaissance music research in the post-war period," invited presentation at the Troja Symposium 2021: *Josquin-Bilder im langen 20. Jahrhundert*, virtual (June 2021)

"The 1520s Project: Bridging the Stylistic Gap with Digital Musical Scores," at the Stanford Center for Spatial and Textual Analysis Digital Humanities Research Symposium, virtual (May 2021)

"The 'In Between' Generation: Mid Sixteenth-Century Polyphony and the Long Shadow of Early Twentieth-Century German Historiography," at the annual meeting of the Northern California Chapter of the American Musicological Society, virtual (May 2021)

"The Popularization of Pervasive Imitation," at the annual meeting of the Renaissance Society of America (RSA), virtual (April 2021)

"New Folks Omitting Strokes? The Mensural Sign C, Adrian Willaert's *Verbum bonum*, and the Emergence of the Imitation Generation," invited lecture for a meeting of the colloquium *Musik vor 1600*, virtual (February 2021)

"The Imitation Generation," at the annual meeting of the Medieval and Renaissance Music Conference (MedRen), virtual (July 2020)

"The ~~Post-Josquin~~ Imitation Generation," invited lecture at the Institut für Musikwissenschaft, Universität Regensburg (January 2020)

"Identity and Bullshit in Imitation Mass Quotations," with Jesse Rodin, invited presentation at *Counterpoints: Renaissance Music and Scholarly Debate in the Digital Domain*, Centre d'Études Supérieures de la Renaissance, Tours (November 2019)

Conferences

Second International Digital Musicology Conference, organizing committee, October 2026
Organizing the second session of the biennial conference held by the Fryderyk Chopin Institute in Krakow. Organizing workshops and presenting on Mapping the Musical Renaissance.

First International Digital Musicology Conference, organizing committee, October 2024
Organized the inaugural session of the biennial conference held at the Fryderyk Chopin Institute in Warsaw. Led workshops on database creation, website construction, and digital mapping using Leaflet. Presented corpus analyses using data from The 1520s Project.

Public Musicology

"Die Musikhistoriographie im Frühen 20. Jahrhundert und der Rolle Senfls," invited lecture at the Singer Pur Tage, Adlersberg, Regensburg (August 2022)

"Eileen Southern and the Music of Black Americans," Harvard University, editor, 2021
Edited module on early music scholarship for digital exhibition on Eileen Southern, the first Black woman tenured in Harvard University's Faculty of Arts and Sciences

Program Notes, Stanford University Orchestras, 2018–19

"Stanford Musicologist Brings the Fifteenth Century to Life," *Stanford News Service*, 2017
http://news.stanford.edu/2017/04/14/stanford-musicologist-brings-15th-century-life/

Service

American Musicological Society, proposal reader for annual conference, 2023

Harvard Krokodiloes Board of Directors, 2014–2024
Oversaw policy and management of the Harvard Krokodiloes, Inc., a 501(c)(3) nonprofit organization managing over $750,000 in funds. Advised undergraduates about financial and communication decisions. As co-chair of the development subcommittee from 2018 to 2024, increased active donors by 30%.

Stanford Graduate Music Students Forum, co-founder, 2017–22
Secured funds for graduate-student projects. Co-wrote organization's constitution. Served as faculty representative, 2017–18; secretary, 2017–18; and technology coordinator, 2018–21.

Karol Berger 70th Birthday Celebration Conference, conference co-organizer, 2018
Organized presentations, concert, and receptions for the conference "Music as Art: Theory Philosophy and the Western Canon," at the Stanford Humanities Center.

Stanford Vice Provost for Graduate Education Grant, grant coordinator, 2018
Stanford Vice Provost for Teaching and Learning, graduate representative, 2017
Stanford Musicology Journal Club, co-founder, 2015–17
Harvard Music Department Faculty Council, undergraduate representative, 2012–13

Music Performance

Convivium Musicum, Boston, tenor, 2018
Harpsichord and Continuo Study, Stanford University, 2017–18
Facsimile Singers, Stanford University, tenor, 2016–17
Convivium, Stanford University, tenor, 2015–17
Harvard Krokodiloes, Harvard University, tenor, 2012–14
Harvard Choruses, Harvard University, tenor, 2010–14

Languages

German (C1.1+), Italian, French, Dutch
Goethe Institut B2 Exam Certification in German, 2016

Technical Skills

CSS, Git/GitHub, HTML, Humdrum, JavaScript, Jekyll, Leaflet.js, and Unix.
Expertise in interactive mapping, data management, and technical documentation.
Experience with C, C++, and Cloudflare.

Professional Memberships

American Musicological Society
Gesellschaft für Musikforschung
Internationale Heinrich-Schütz-Gesellschaft
International Musicological Society
Koninklijke Vereniging voor Nederlandse Muziekgeschiedenis
Schweizerische Musikforschende Gesellschaft

Updated

October 2026